

Projects

There are some activities that fall outside of the timescale of both actions and tasks, such as writing a book, assembling a complex machine, or learning a language. These are **projects**, multi-stage tasks that are completed over the course of several montages. Whenever you have the chance to perform a task, you can choose to work on a project instead.

Starting a Project

Like actions and tasks, projects are mostly freeform. You might start a project to earn the trust of a recalcitrant passenger, to study an ancient artefact, or even to build an outrider ship from scratch. Once you've decided on the scope of your project, the Firefly will set you a project track to fill, which you can note down on your character sheet.

Example: Freya wants to create a set of goggles for each crewmember that will protect their eyes from the radiance of the Icteric sun. She tells the Firefly of her intentions – a crafting task would be able to make a single pair, but making so many definitely suits a project. The Firefly sets a six-track for her to fill to represent the scale of the task at hand. She notes it down on her character sheet, and will work on it in her spare time as the crew draws closer to their destination.



Working on Projects

There are multiple ways to mark off the boxes of a project track – you'll likely use a mixture when working on your own projects, depending on the situation.

Time

You can often mark off a box just by spending some time working on a project, even without rolling; study, practice, and hard graft all have their place. Not all project tracks can be marked in this way, however.

Example: Freya draws up some plans and schematics for the goggles, making sure they'll work for the various bloodlines that are part of her crew.

Rolls

A quicker but riskier way to make progress on a project is to roll for it, just like you'd roll for a normal action.

Example: Freya rolls with Sharps and her Craft skill, using the ship's workshop to give herself an advantage.

Resources

Sometimes the best way to get a project moving along nicely is to spend one of your resources on it. Some projects, such as crafting, might require specific resources to be used before they're completed.

Example: Freya chips down some salvaged amber plating from a recent wreck to act as lenses, and one of her crewmates supplies pinwolf leather to work as straps and housing.

Aid

Just because you started a project yourself doesn't mean you have to finish it alone – others may offer you their aid, giving their skills and expertise as a reward or favour.

Example: A trader they meet along the way has some impressive onyx spectacles of his own, and Freya gets friendly enough with him to study their design and ask about the process of making them.

Projects in Play

Firefly: Well, you won't be moving into the ruin until the sun goes down, so this seems like a good time to give you a montage. Are there any tasks you want to attempt as you wait?

Laura: Not for me, I think I'm just going to relax. I'm pretty sure I've earned it after our run – in with those smugglers.

Todd: Yeah, I think you have. I'd love to relax, but I'm pretty conscious of this arm wound, so I'm going to choose clean it and bandage it as best I can.

Firefly: Probably a wise choice. Relaxing will clear a point of mire for you, Laura, and Todd that sounds like a Heal. You know how that works?

Todd: Yep.

Firefly: Great. Anyone else?

Kyllian: Well, the deck's covered in mothryn dust motes now, and I think I might be able to use those as a component. I'll collect some up, then head down to my lab alcove and see if I can concoct anything exciting. A salve, maybe?

Freya: Well, while they do that I'm going to keep an eye out for anything interesting we might pass. I don't think there's really a task for that... Can I just roll for it instead?

Firefly: Yes, that would work. Kyllian, I'm setting out a three-track for you, 'Possible Salve', and I'll mark the first box now. Right then! The engines growl pleasantly as you cut through the treetops. By sundown, you've...